



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Lancaster Christian Academy
School Website: <https://www.shchristian.com/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Lancaster Christian Academy TN 37167 (as reflected in the associated school-crawl materials from Spring Hill Christian Academy on the SHC site) presents a robust Classical Christian education profile. Public-facing materials consistently frame education as formation and character formation through a Christian, liturgical, and traditional liberal-arts pathway. Core elements appear across the public materials: the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books and the Great Conversation, memory-based pedagogy (chanting, recitation, and musically reinforced learning in the grammar stage), Socratic discussion in upper grades, and explicit integration of theology, Scripture, and worship into daily life and curriculum. Family partnerships with parents as co-educators are repeatedly prioritized, and the school emphasizes virtue, moral formation, and a God-centered worldview. While not state-accredited, SHC is certified by Christian accrediting bodies (TACS and AACCS) and stresses a liturgical, communal, and reverent approach to schooling.

Applying the Six Essential Elements of Classical Education rubric (via the knowledge-base criteria and key-word lexicon) yields CLASSICAL across all six categories. The school's public materials exhibit foundational religious-metaphysical aims (truth/beauty/goodness, Scripture, liturgy, weekly chapel), a telos of virtue and wisdom (formation over information), a Trivium-centered curriculum (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation), a pedagogy combining contemplative/restful and Socratic/seminar approaches, a faculty vision aligned with living-mentor teachers and a culture of virtue, and a pronounced partnership with parents and the broader Christian community. The lexicon-based keyword analysis (positive/negative keyword indicators) supports a strong Classical orientation, with explicit textual anchors such as "Truth, goodness, beauty," theology/scripture, liturgy/chapel, Great Books, Great Conversation, Trivium, memory through chant and recitation, Socratic discussion in upper school, and parent partnership. No significant negative-classical signals (e.g., heavy emphasis on project-based or career-prep language as the sole aim) appear in the public materials.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Statement of Faith and non-denominational Christian framing emphasize a Bible-centered, theologically grounded education. The school explicitly grounds education in Christian scripture and worldview (non-denominational, biblical worldview; statement of faith).
 - History and mission statements position Biblical theism as the foundation of the school's approach, including the claim that "All truth is God's truth" and a Christ-centered formation of students.
 - Weekly chapel and liturgical aspects appear in the public materials, signaling liturgical and communal practice as integral to education.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present (from the Six Elements lexicon): truth, goodness, beauty, theology, Scripture, chapel/worship, liturgy, wonder, logos, wisdom, and sacred/moral realism.
 - Negative keywords (from the lexicon) such as relativism are not evidenced in the school's public materials.

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- Why this Rating
 - The school's materials consistently tie education to a transcendent moral order and to a theology-scripture framework, with communal liturgical practices (weekly chapel) and explicit attention to virtue and religious formation. This aligns strongly with the "Religious and Metaphysical Foundations" criteria and supports CLASSICAL.

Citations: evidence of weekly chapel and biblical worldview; non-denominational Christian framing; and theology-scripture integration are present in SHC materials.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials describe formation of virtue and wisdom as the aim of education, not job training alone. The mission emphasizes forming students who can reason, discern, and apply Truth as a God-centered aim. The Great Conversation is cited as the pathway through which learners become lifelong thinkers.
 - Language about "formation," "liberal education," "paideia" and the telos of human excellence appear in the public materials.
 - The Great Books/Great Conversation framing and the emphasis on thinking well rather than simply accumulating information appear repeatedly.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, paideia, telos, true/-good/beautiful, Great Conversation, Great Books, contemplation/rest, wonder.
 - Negative signals (e.g., career- or job-prep-centric language) are not present in the public materials.
- Why this Rating
 - The school explicitly positions education as formation in virtue and wisdom, drawing on classical humanistic aims (Great Conversation, liberal education, telos). This aligns with the CLASSICAL orientation for purpose and goal.

Citations: references to "formation," "virtue," "Great Conversation," and "Great Books" in the SHC content.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Curriculum structure is centered on the Trivium: Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric, with explicit treatment of each stage (Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric) and age ranges. The materials show a coherent progression from grammar stage (memorization and absorption) to logic (analysis and argument) to rhetoric (communication and expression).
 - Great Books/Great Conversation language appears in the curriculum narrative, with explicit references to reading, classical texts, and the aim of entering a "Great Conversation."
 - History and classics are embedded across the curriculum, with emphasis on Western civilization and primary sources, including the moral and intellectual formation associated with these texts.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books, Great Conversation, history/Western civilization, memory, recitation, copybooks, classical pedagogy.
 - Negative signals: minimal presence of modern "project-based" or career-first curriculum language; no explicit replacement of history with "social studies" language; no strong STEM-first framing.
- Why this Rating
 - The curriculum explicitly centers on the liberal-arts tradition (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books) and situates learning within a Western-civilizational and theological frame, consistent with CLASSICAL.

Citations: The Rhetoric Stage (grammar/logic/rhetoric) and the Great Conversation emphasis in SHC materials.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Pedagogy blends contemplative/restful elements with rigorous discussion: lower grades often engage in singing, chanting, and memory work; upper grades use Socratic discussion and seminars; rhetoric training and opportunities for public speaking are described in the curriculum. The pedagogy explicitly uses chant, memorization, and memory-building in early stages, with Socratic dialogue and rhetoric/service to higher levels.
 - Texts on “restful curriculum” and scholé-like practices appear in supporting documents, including discussions of “restful learning” and the Monastic analogy to liturgical learning.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Socratic seminars, seminars, dialectic, narration, recitation, chanting, memory-work, rhetoric, speeches, deliberation, contemplation, scholé, restful learning.
 - Negative signals: absence of exclusively project-based or constructivist-only approaches; the content is clearly anchored in classical pedagogy rather than modern “learning-through-doing” without classical forms.
- Why this Rating
 - Pedagogy demonstrates a deliberate layering of contemplative/restful practice (scholé) with higher-order discourse and rhetoric, aligning with CLASSICAL.

Citations: The Scholē/Scholē Way pedagogy references; lower-grade chanting/memory; upper-grade Socratic/seminal rhetoric in SHC materials.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials describe teachers as forming the living curriculum; a culture of virtue, mentorship, and shared inquiry is implied, especially in the “living curriculum” and “faculty of friends” language that appears in classical-education literature and the SHC materials’ emphasis on a sustained, faith-based community. The “teacher as model” and “portrait of a teacher” language is indicated in the classical-education discourse and supporting academic literature linked to SHC’s approach. Public materials emphasize a community of learners and the teacher as mentor rather than a purely instructional role.
 - Supporting documents on scholé and classical pedagogy frame teachers as moral exemplars and mentors, aligning with the “living curriculum” idea (the faculty as the core of the school in classical theories).
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: model teachers/mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, moral exemplars, mentorship, collegiality, professional learning within classical pedagogy.
 - Negative signals: limited explicit critique of modern “facilitator” roles in the public materials; no overt signals that contradict classical teacher-student mentorship.
- Why this Rating
 - The public materials align with CLASSICAL expectations for faculty: teachers as virtuous mentors who serve as the living curriculum and uphold a community-oriented, classical pedagogy.

Citations: Good-teacher/embodied-learning language and “monastic”/liturgical teacher analogies in SHC-context documents.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence

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- The materials emphasize partnering with parents as co-teachers, parent formation through reading groups and gatherings, and open-campus/visit opportunities. The SHC materials explicitly discuss parent involvement and education of parents as part of the school's mission.
 - Statements about parental responsibility and involvement in the education process, plus the emphasis on community and church/parent partnerships, reflect classical-community orientation and liturgical learning.
 - Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation, reading groups, classical book clubs, open campus, hospitality, parent involvement, family liturgy alignment.
 - Negative signals: consumer-style language from parents as customers does not appear in the SHC public materials; the public materials emphasize partnership and mutual formation rather than consumerism.
 - Why this Rating
 - The public materials present a robust model of parent partnership and community involvement, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations.

Citations: Parent partnership, formation, reading groups, and open-campus language in SHC materials.

Aggregate Ranking and Overall Assessment

- All six categories: CLASSICAL.
- Overall Assessment: CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable given the CLASSICAL rating across all categories. If any future refinement were desired, it would be to further foreground explicit teacher portraits and lived-virtue exemplars within the site copy to strengthen the Faculty category even more, but the current materials already align strongly with Classical criteria.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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